

Wilka Torrico De Carvalho, *Aspiring Cognitive Scientist and AI Researcher*

CONTACT INFORMATION	Website: wcarvalho.github.io Github: github.com/wcarvalho E-mail: wcarvalh@umich.edu Google Scholar
RESEARCH INTERESTS	My long-term goal is to develop cognitive theories of learning that help us understand how humans infer, reason with, and exploit the rich structure present in realistic visual scenes to enable rapid adaptation to a broad range of ecological situations. Towards this end, I am currently studying how learning algorithms which discover schemata can bring us closer to human-level artificial intelligence.
EDUCATION	University of Michigan—Ann Arbor, Ann Arbor, Michigan USA <i>School of Engineering</i>, Ph.D. in Computer Science Advisors: Honglak Lee, Satinder Singh, Richard Lewis Sep 2018 - Present University of Southern California, Los Angeles, California USA <i>Viterbi School of Engineering</i>, M.S. in Computer Science Advisor: Yan Liu Aug 2015 - May 2017 Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, New York USA <i>College of Arts and Sciences</i>, B.S. in Physics Advisor: Axel Drees Aug 2011 - May 2015 Brooklyn Technical High School, Brooklyn, New York USA Diploma in Applied Physics May 2007 - May 2011
HONORS & AWARDS	1/200 chosen internationally for Heidelberg Laureate Forum2018 GEM National Fellowship sponsored by IBM, Adobe2017, 2018 University of Michigan Rackham Merit Fellowship2017 ICLR, Neurips BAI Travel Award2017, 2019 NSF Graduate Research Fellowship (Neuroscience)2015 Provost Award for Academic Excellence (~ 0.5% of graduates chosen)2015 Researcher of the Month (1 monthly at Stony Brook University)2014 HHMI Minority Undergraduate Research Fellowship2014 ΣΠΣ Physics Honor Society (sponsored by Alfred Goldhaber)2013 NSF Louis Stokes Alliance for Minority Participation Scholar2011 Deans List2011-2015
CONFERENCE PUBLICATIONS	Wilka Carvalho, Anthony Liang, Kimin Lee, Sungryull Sohn, Richard L. Lewis, Satinder Singh, Honglak Lee. “<i>Reinforcement Learning for Sparse-Reward Object-Interaction Tasks in First-person Simulated 3D Environments.</i>” In IJCAI, 2021 (Invited Talk at NeurIPS) Sanjay Purushotham*, Wilka Carvalho*, Tanachat Nilanon, Yan Liu. “<i>Variational Recurrent Adversarial Domain Adaptation.</i>” In ICLR, 2017 Wilka Carvalho. “<i>Modeling a Detection of internally reflected Cherenkov light (DIRC) Particle Detector for High-Multiplicity Collisions.</i>” In SURC, 2015
WORKSHOP PUBLICATIONS	Wilka Carvalho, Murray Shanahan. “<i>Learning to Represent State with Perceptual Schemata.</i>” In ICML {Unsupervised RL, Real Life RL} Workshops, 2021 Wilka Carvalho, Anthony Liang, Kimin Lee, Sungryull Sohn, Richard L. Lewis, Satinder Singh, Honglak Lee. “<i>Reinforcement Learning for Sparse-Reward Object-Interaction Tasks in First-person</i>

Simulated 3D Environments.” In {ICML Object-Oriented Learning, NeurIPS DeepRL} Workshops, 2020

Chris Hoang, Sungryull Sohn, Jongwook Choi, **Wilka Carvalho**, Honglak Lee. “*Successor Landmarks for Efficient Exploration and Long-Horizon Navigation.*” In NeurIPS DeepRL Workshop, 2020

Wilka Carvalho, Kimin Lee, Anthony Liang, Ryan Krueger, Richard L. Lewis, Satinder Singh, Honglak Lee. “*Efficiently Learning to Perform Household Task with Object-oriented Exploration.*” In NeurIPS BAI, 2019 (**Oral**)

Bryant Chen*, **Wilka Carvalho***, Benjamin Edwards, Taesung Lee, Ian Molloy, Heiko Ludwig. “*Detecting Backdoor Attacks on Deep Neural Networks by Activation Clustering.*” In AAAI Artificial Intelligence Safety Workshop, 2018 (**Best Paper**)

Sanjay Purushotham*, **Wilka Carvalho***, Yan Liu. “*Variational Adversarial Deep Domain Adaptation for Health Care Time Series Analysis.*” In NeurIPS Machine Learning for Healthcare Workshop, 2016 (**Spotlight**)

PATENTS

Bryant Chen, **Wilka Carvalho**, Heiko Ludig, Ian Molloy, Jialong Zhang, Benjamin Edwards. “*Detecting poisoning attacks on neural networks by activation clustering.*” 2020

Wilka Carvalho, Bryant Chen, Benjamin Edwards, Taesung Lee, Ian Molloy, Jialong Zhang. “*Using Gradients to Detect Backdoors in Neural Networks.*” 2018

Wilka Carvalho, Yan Liu, Tanachat Nilanon, Sanjay Purushotham. “*Effective Knowledge Transfer Among Patient Populations via Deep Learning.*” 2017

INVITED TALKS

Computational Cognitive Neuroscience Lab. University of California—Berkeley. (September, 2021)
Object Representations for Learning and Reasoning Workshop. NeurIPS. (December, 2020)
Cognitive Tools Lab. University of California—San Diego. (November, 2020)
Cognitive Science Community. University of Michigan. (November, 2020)
Stony Brook Society of Physics. Stony Brook, NY. (April, 2020)
Machine Learning Lunch Seminar. University of Southern California. (April, 2017)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Michigan—Ann Arbor, Ann Arbor, Michigan USA
AI Lab, August 2018 – Present

Advisors: [Honglak Lee](#), [Satinder Singh](#), [Richard Lewis](#)

- Studying how deep reinforcement learning agents can discover representations and temporally-extended behaviors that enable generalization

DeepMind, London, UK
Cognition Team, March 2021 – July 2021
Advisor: [Murray Shanahan](#)

- Studying agent-state representations for generalization of deep reinforcement learning agents in 3D environments

Microsoft Research, Redmond, Washington USA
Medical Devices Group, June 2018 – August 2018
Advisor: [Sumit Basu](#)

- Developed a machine learning model that can predict clinical measures from physiological signals measured by a wearable device.

IBM Research, San Jose, California USA

AI Platform Research Group, *September 2017 – December 2017*

Advisor: [Heiko Ludwig](#)

- Contributed to novel research algorithm by suggesting subspace projection technique that increased our performance from 15% to 95% accuracy.
- Research led to workshop publication and was presented in global meeting to IBM executives including CEO and selected for funding.

Visa Research, Palo Alto, California USA

Data Analytics Group, *June 2017 – August 2017*

Advisor: [Hao Yang](#)

- Implemented model and baselines for language generation and question answering.

University of Southern California, Los Angeles, California USA

Melady Machine Learning Lab, *November 2015 – May 2017*

Advisor: [Yan Liu](#)

Samsung and NSF funded project: “Variational Adversarial Deep Domain Adaptation for Health Care Time Series Analysis”

- Implemented novel neural network that employed variational inference and adversarial training for transfer learning of multivariate time-series.
- Research led to a publication and a patent.
- Communicated research to general public through research feature by the USC Graduate School and to technical audience at ICLR poster presentation.

Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, New York USA

Heavy Ion Research Group, *January 2013 – August 2015*

Advisor: [Axel Drees](#)

DOE funded project: “Modeling a Detection of internally reflected Cherenkov light Particle Detector for High-Multiplicity Collisions”

- Contributed methods from multivariate calculus and linear algebra to particle detection algorithm. Accuracy improved from 60% to 80%.
- Designed and implemented a statistical analysis pipeline in C++ for measuring efficacy of particle detection algorithm.

Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, New York USA

Computational Neuroscience Group, *Fall 2014*

Advisor: [Giancarlo La Camera](#)

NSF LSAMP funded project: “Spectral Analysis of Rodent Neural Data”

- Performed spectral analyses on neural data to determine behavioral correlates of neural activity.

California Institute of Technology, Pasadena, California USA

Emotion and Social Cognition Laboratory, *Summer 2014*

Advisor: [Ralph Adolphs](#)

HHMI funded project: “Modeling the Cognitive Process of Attributing Traits to Others”

- Formulated a trait learning behavioral experiment to study human inference.

University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota USA

Neuromodulation Research and Technology Laboratory, *Summer 2013*

Advisor: [Matthew Johnson](#)

NIH funded project: “Modeling Deep Brain Stimulation of Globus Pallidus Internus”

- Implemented python script to build a biologically feasible computational model of neural networks

National Central University, Jhongli City, Taiwan
Turbulent Combustion Laboratory, *Summer 2012*
Advisor: [Shenqyang Shy](#)

TEACHING
EXPERIENCE

Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, NY
Calculus Instructor, *Spring 2015*
Worked with two math professors to develop and teach a supplementary calculus curriculum that promoted minority representation in stem majors.

Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, NY
Educational Opportunity Program Personal Tutor, *Spring 2013 - Fall 2014*
Tutored marginalized students in introductory physics and math courses

SERVICE

Reviewer, NeurIPS Deep Reinforcement Learning Workshop, 2020
Student Volunteer, ICLR, 2017

OUTREACH

HS2 Engineer's Highschool Panel, Virtual, 2021
Stony Brook Society of Physics, Stony Brook, NY, 2020
Michigan Explore Graduate Studies Workshop, Ann Arbor, MI, 2019
Research and Fellowships Week NSF Panel, Los Angeles, CA, 2016
National Society of Black Engineers Grad Panel, Los Angeles, CA, 2016
Graduate School External Fellowship Boot Camp, Los Angeles, CA, 2016
Mentored marginalized high school youth through the Pullias Center for Higher Education, Los Angeles, CA, 2016
Engineering Graduate Diversity Symposium, Los Angeles, CA, 2015
Black Student Association: What it takes to go to Graduate School, Los Angeles, CA, 2015
Collegiate Science and Technology Entry Program Undergraduate Research Panel, Stony Brook, CA, 2014

SKILLS

Machine Learning Software: Pytorch, TensorFlow, Theano, Keras
Neuroscience Software: Neuron
Languages: Python, C++, C, Java
Systems: Unix, Linux, OSX

PRESS

[Finding Gaps in Your Grad School Apps](#)
[This Week In Machine Learning \(TWIML\) Research Feature](#)
[University of Michigan Research Feature](#)
[Exploring the source of social stereotypes](#)
[Black History Month: Why a career in science?](#)
[Research Feature by the USC Graduate School](#)
[2015 NSF Graduate Research Fellow Wilka Carvalho](#)
[Biomath Learning Center Launches Modified Supplemental Instruction Program](#)
[URECA Research of the Month: Wilka Carvalho](#)
[Student Feature by Stony Brook University](#)

INTERESTS

● traveling ● chess ● software development ● improvisational dance ● deadpan humor